ADAM SIMMS

WEBSITE
art.adamsimms.xyz

SUMMARY

Adam Simms is a Canadian media artist based between Tiohtiá:ke/Montréal and Ktaqmkuk/Newfoundland. He works with photography, video, and microelectronics, building installations, sculptures, and machines that transmit landscape and the vernacular from remote sites to unexpected locations. His subject is belonging, displacement, and intangible culture: which parts of a culture are portable, and which are rooted in place. The resettlement of his grandmother from Pinchard's Island under the 1960s centralization program weaves in and out of his work.

In *Cabin* (2018) he rebuilt a Newfoundland cabin in a Montréal studio around a live feed from *Cloudberry* (2017-2018), a solar-powered camera fixed to a family cabin on Pinchard's Island. *Driftwood* (2018) translates live data from a buoy in the Atlantic Ocean into motion. Those works were created at Concordia University, during the MFA in Studio Arts (Photography) he received in 2021. He has taught undergraduate photography there as an Artist-in-Residence (2021-2022, 2024-2025).

He is currently building an off-grid, networked field rover for Pinchard's Island: a camera system and a language model that writes observational field notes from fragmentary dialect. With decades of experience as a software designer and developer, he designs and builds the systems his projects require. He intends the rover to become an open, unfinished record Newfoundlanders, researchers, and artists can shape with archives, oral histories, and memories, as a way of holding intangible culture in place.

EDUCATION

Master of Fine Arts — Studio Arts, Photography 2021
Concordia University, Montréal, Québec

Bachelor of Fine Arts — Design Major, Photography Minor 2013
Concordia University, Montréal, Québec

SELECTED EXHIBITIONS AND PUBLIC ART

Pinchard's Island 2021
Concordia University, Montréal, Québec
MFA thesis exhibition.

Barrens 2020
Milieux Institute for Arts, Culture and Technology, Montréal, Québec

IGNITION 14 (Curated. Paid an artist fee.) 2018
Galerie Leonard & Bina Ellen Art Gallery, Montréal, Québec

Les Inéluctables (Curated. Paid an artist fee.) 2017
Occurrence, espace d'art et d'essai contemporains, Montréal, Québe

ARTSIDA7 (Curated.) 2017
Musée d'art contemporain de Montréal, Montréal, Québec

Festival des Promenades Photographiques (Curated.) 2013
Mark Gosset, Vendôme, France

Dénouement 2013
VAV Gallery, Montréal, Québec

Art For Healing Foundation (Curated.) 2012
Montréal, Québec

Conclusions 2012
Eastern Bloc, Montréal, Québec

À Louer (Curated.) 2011–2012
UMA, Montréal, Québec

Washed-up 2010
KaVieArt, Montréal, Québec

PUBLISHED WORK

Dînette – Issue 020: Trésor, *Pour ne jamais oublier* 2021

Riddle Fence, Issue 14, Barrens 2013

The Goose – Issue 12, *Unsettled* 2013

Headlight Anthology, Issue 15,
Barrens: LOST, FOUND, and STOLEN 2012

Interfold, Spring Issue, Barrens 2012

TEACHING

Artist-in-Residence, Studio Arts 2024–2025
Concordia University, Montréal, Québec

- Photographic Vision: Theory & Practice II (PHOT 300)
- Advanced Workshop in Photography (PHOT 400)
- Digital Photography I (PHOT 331)
- Digital Photography II (PHOT 332)

Artist-in-Residence, Studio Arts 2021–2022
Concordia University, Montréal, Québec

- As Seen on Screens: Cyberspace & Image Economy (PHOT 398)
- Digital Photography I (PHOT 331)

Teaching Assistant — Geneviève Cadieux 2017
Concordia University, Montréal, Québec

- Advanced Workshop in Photography (PHOT 400)

Teaching Assistant — Marisa Portolese 2016
Concordia University, Montréal, Québec

- Photographic Vision: Theory and Practice (PHOT 300)

RESIDENCIES WORKSHOPS MEMBERSHIPS

Silence Awareness Existence (Residency. Upcoming) 2027
Arteles Creative Center, Hämeenkyrö, Finland

La Wayaka Current: Desert 23°S (Residency. Upcoming) 2026
Arts & Ecology Research Residency, Atacama, Chile

Post Image Cluster (Research Member) 2016-Present
Milieux Institute for Arts, Culture and Technology, Montréal, Québec

Self-directed Research + Creation Residencies 2015–2022
Pinchard's Island, Newfoundland

Wilderness + Conservation Photography Workshop 2012
The Banff Centre, Banff, Alberta

Le Mois de la Photo — Portfolio Review 2011
Montréal, Québec

TALKS

Guest Lecture: Virtual Identity for Artists — Survival Tactics 2026
Concordia University, Montréal, Québec

Artist Talk — Portraiture & Identity 2024
Concordia University, Montréal, Québec

Artist Talk, Photographic Vision: Theory & Practice II 2021
Concordia University, Montréal, Québec

Artist Talk — Advanced Workshop in Photography 2020
Concordia University, Montréal, Québec

AWARDS

Concordia Merit Scholarship 2016
Faculty of Fine Arts, Concordia University

Flash Forward Emerging Photographers 2013
Magenta Foundation

Best of College Photography Finalist 2011
Photographer's Forum

Canadian Millennium Scholarship 2007, 2008, 2009

MEDIA COVERAGE

Concordia University, *IGNITION 14 art show features Jane Austen, roadside restaurants and hanging logs* 2018

Radio-Canada, *Des photographies géantes dans les commerces vacants* 2013

Ciel Variable (CV92), *À Louer,* James D. Campbell 2012

The Montreal Gazette, *Photographs jog our memories and our morals,* John Pohl 2011

The Montreal Mirror, *Urban Driftwood,* Stacey DeWolfe 2010

The Nor'wester, *Snapping success,* Clyde Follett 2010

RELATED PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Technology + Design Advisor 2020–Present
adamsimms.xyz, Montréal

Head of Technology 2021–2023
Age of Union, Montréal

Head of Design 2018–2019
Lightspeed, Montréal

Product Designer 2013–2018
Trello + Atlassian, New York

Research Assistant — Marisa Portolese 2012–2014
Concordia University, Montréal

Senior Designer 2007–2013
Lightspeed, Montréal